

insight ■ tips and tricks

you want in your gradient. Your Color Stop will take on this colour. Add another Color Stop by clicking just to the right of your first stop under the Gradient bar. Again, move outside the Gradient Editor into your image and sample the next colour. Keep adding stops and sampling colours until you have the required gradient effect. Give the gradient a name in the Name field and click on the New button to add this to the Gradient picker so that you can access it easily.

Erasing back to your original image

When editing an image, to revert to an earlier stage, select the Eraser tool (instead of **File > Revert**, which will revert to the original image). Press down [Alt] and start erasing the areas you don't want to keep. Usually the Eraser tool erases the image, but when you hold down the [Alt] key, it acts like a history eraser and

erases back to how the image looked originally.

Changing colour and luminosity effects

Open your RGB image and make a copy of it. Now press



You can add cool effects by changing the image luminosity



[Ctrl] + [I] to invert your image in the new layer. Go to the Layers palette and change the blend mode from Normal to Difference in the inverted layer mode. Now make a copy of the original background layer and place it above the inverted layer. Finally, change the layer blend mode from Normal to Luminosity.

mouse away from the text, it changes into the Move tool. You can now move the Type in the Edit mode too. The moment you bring the mouse nearer to the text, the cursor blinks again and you can edit the text again.

You [Enter] only once

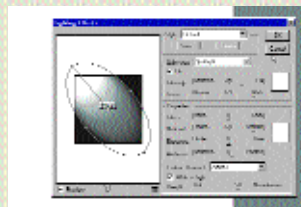
In the edit mode, when you press [Enter], the cursor goes to a new line. When you finish editing, press [Enter] on the Numeric keypad. This will finish the editing task and the cursor will turn into a Move tool.

Metal and chrome effect

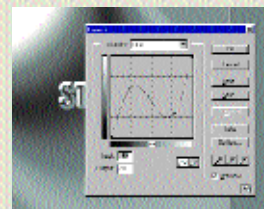
Open a new document in RGB mode and type in **Steel**. Hold down the [Ctrl] key and click on your Type layer in the Layers palette to put a selection around your text. Now under the Select menu, choose Save Selection. Press [Ctrl] + [D] to deselect and then delete the Type Layer.



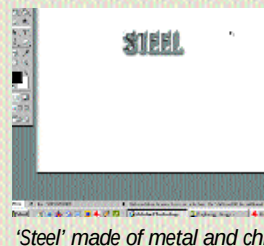
This is the text without the effect



The Lightning Effects dialog box with the angle setting for the light



Get your curve to look like the



Go on to the Channels palette and click on Alpha Next, under **Filter > Blur > Gaussian Blur**, enter 1 pixel. Select the background layer and under **Filter > Render > Lightning Effects**, go to Text Channel and choose Alpha 1; click OK.

Now press [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Ctrl] + [J] to put the entire image on its own layer.

Under **Image > Adjustments**, choose Curves, create a curve like the one shown above, by clicking on the lower left hand side of the curve and dragging upwards. Release the mouse button and then click on the right hand side and click down to give it a chrome effect. Once you get a curve similar to the one in the figure, click OK. Now choose Load Selection from the Select menu. Make sure Alpha 1 is selected under Channel popup. From the Select menu, choose **Modify > Expand**. Here you need to evaluate how many pixels

TEXT EFFECTS

Some shortcuts and effects that will make your text stand out

Kerning text

The kerning effect is used to crunch or expand words while retaining even spacing between letters. Just select the word you want to kern and press [Ctrl] + [Alt] + left/right arrow. This will increase or decrease the spacing by 100 points. On pressing the [Ctrl] + [Alt] + up/down arrow key,

the leading changes by 10 points. To increase or decrease the font size, press [Shift] + [Ctrl] + [>] or [<].

Moving Type in Edit mode

Haven't you always wished to be able to move the text to its proper position while you edit? As soon as you take the